

17/10/24

Started off with the Barbarian's arm wrestling. Bunny won! Bard immediately got up to the tricks to stop from paying out the betting pool.

Need to figure out why Lord Farquart is stealing kids and dumbing them down. Got to talk to someone about his daughter and someone else at the docks for their son?

Got a note from Lady De Beauvoir (SP) for aid in ridding her manner of ghosts. Got invited to come along with.

House was in the fancy part of town, Victorian town house style. Cow's head door knocker. Garish red decor. A middle- aged woman finally arrived along with the Tea, Lady Bligh.

Turns out she and the kids were both being haunted: Dwane, Dakota, Diana, Derrick. Husband Bert

Haunting started a couple months back, originally minor misfortunes. Lately it has become more violent. Possessions too. Even every other night.

Nona Loiuse died 'in her sleep' around the time it started, she was a florist and the step-mother.

The housekeeper, Mystica, took us to Nona Louise' room, which is currently Stark White. All of it was brand new since she's died. Previously used to be pink, furniture stashed in the attic.

Furniture's been freshly moved here. Any notes are mutterings of an old lady. There's the faint scent of lilacs and lilies drenched on the furniture. There's a small vial with an unmarked clear liquid hidden under the mattress.

Got info out of Mystica. Nona was disliked by Bligh's side of the family because she was withholding money because she felt Bert deserved better and wanted to move out. Because Bert married a commoner, Bligh. Scandalous because she took his name.

Bligh's business partner from Covard works with exotic herbs, poisons, etc.

Some poisons from Covard can cause a sleep like death, some of which smell like lavender.

High-Lady Dawn signed off on the Death Certificate.

Mystica took us to the Sea Blue playroom to talk to the kids. Dwane's the oldest at 12, reading a book and giving it the People's Eyebrow. Dakota (7) and Diana (6) are playing cards, Derrick's (4) watching.

They've all been possessed and loose time but she doesn't seem malicious towards them, goes back to happy memories. Dwane, The Rock, De Beauvoir, is naturally talented at the Dulcimer and kept Gilber's after he tried it. Doesn't directly communicate with them.

When possessed they arrange flower, go up and down stairs, pull faces at family portrait paintings.

Suggested we get Mystica to make Moon Tea

24/10/24

Stopped by the Magic shop on the way to the Church to pick up some earrings of message. At the Church is a mausoleum and graveyard. Seemed to have an issue with giant eagles... Not the first time they've dealt with poison. There was some at the ball too... Similar stuff.

Took us to the office, very Library like. Lots of skulls. Animal, of course.

Confirmed it's a similar poison to the one at the ball, but more lethal.

At the party where someone was poisoned and everyone carried on...

Matrimonial leader who they return the locket too was targeted to unravel a peace treaty with High Leader someone... Don't know who's behind it but they suspect Illithie who were aggressors in the war.

Whoever stole that locket was targeting Talis Greanway to draw attention away from the talks.

Peace talks are ongoing.

Suspected the only child of the Greenways would be targeted next. Greenways are the High Leaders of the country.

Went to check on some of the families of abducted kids while waiting for sunset.

To the Docks by the river. Usual traffic. Looking for the McMills house down an alleyway. Artificer was on point, and nervous. Elder woman answered, at least five children in there too. Kid we needed was out on the boat with his dad. Asked them to ask for us at the tavern. Went to check the cobblers instead. Fancy store.

After buying some shoes we finally got to talk to the kid. She went to speak to someone and was waylaid by the paladins. Said she needed to pass a test but was given sweets, then she woke up here. She was found in the Graveyard.

High Lady Dawn's notes said Applesweet's son was the second to be pinched, daughter the first and Evangiline the most recent.

Went ghost hunting.

Got the kids together in one room, no adult supervision. Set up rock salt traps and put the kids to bed...

Then the clock struck midnight.

07/11/24

Grannie

Didn't realise she was dead, confirmed it was Bly. Promised to depart peacefully... wasn't fond of her grandson's dulcimer's hobby. Flagged down a child outside to relay a message to High Lady Dawn and a Sheriff. Dawn got here first. Nona told Dawn what we suspected, Nona would cut Bly off and kick her out for the disruption to the family business. Halfway through the androgynous himbo sheriff Riven Francious arrived and listened in.

Mother came down eventually, told her the news. Mentioned the third floor window again. Got paid, arrested her, she was lying about killing Nona, there's some more evidence in the house, and more elsewhere. Handed her over to the Sherrif (20gp) who took her off. Family had a slaughter house in town, providing a semi-independent butchers ... with Bly's private office above.

The Office

Lee distracted the crowds outside while I got in. Desk, chairs around, kitchenette. Reserved for light bidness, mostly private study.

Lee found a key, opened a desk drawer. Inside was an encoded book. Symbols in there matched others in the ledger. Key was in a book about Covard religions but the inside was about Illithie religion. Camie figured out some of the code. Written in bastard Covardian. Lavender, trade, mystery, death repeated often. Handed it all into the Sheriff for a pat on the head.

The families of the abducted.

Tavern owner told us the prices (2sp per head per night, upto 6 by now) and told us the McMillis were back. Had breakfast and went to investigate.

Mother called Rupert, 8yrs old, to come talk to us. Boy was a part of Lady Dusk's schooling. Birthing rites. He was at the top of his class. The 'vow of silence' was new since his abduction, as was struggling with basic maths and hand-eye skills. Had drunk sugary tea. Paladins seem to have abducted him again, those with the blue sash. Wrote what happened when he got there.

Went to alter place, spirit not in body, saw three paladins in blue on the other side?

Saw green flower, heard Ilithe 4 in yellow. Saw men in blue with big sword.

Big guy had black hair with a blindfold on. Rather tall, with a really big sword.

Seems there's someone else in their head right now. Ask the clerics about a cast of detect thoughts.

14/11/24

Got Jarvak back to Dawn to cure him of old age. Seemed tentative that yellow paladins might have a connection with Illithie, and the Green flower might have something to do with Rulana, the shadow huntress/temptress, nature, balance, survival. Checked out the mausoleum, Jarvak kicked open the door... Violently. Took the right path. Found a cockroach spying on us, captured it in a bell.. Jorvik spooked it into talking.

It's name is Roachie, was sent here to watch the magic circle. Was promised food by someone tall, wearing yellow. We returned him to our side. Not seen anyone down here since but they might be trying to ramp up the kidnappings.

The magic circle last time was filled with dead bodies from the party, old guy teleported away. The circle had symbols in Illithian and Covardian, same symbols for Life, Transport, Opportunity/Death, the same ones as in the encoded book from Lady Bligh's office. Seemed to be transporting them North to a waystation. Recognized the symbol for Lavender and another symbol from the book .

Departed for Lord Farquart's

The Bard.... Made an impression on the gardeners with the bagpipes. Managed to ask diplomatically for an audience. Stablehand took the horses and a halfling took us to the house, Rupert. Showed us to a waiting room. Portraits had an elderly couple with a kid either side, dark hair, 18ish, woman in her 20's also dark hair. All halflings. Farquhar Family. Rupert introduced Lord Farquart in his 30's. Intimidating him into spilling didn't work. Didn't ACTUALLY deny being involved, just waffled. Rupert reacted at a mention of 'The Man' . Didn't seem to have sinister connections to kids going missing, said he sponsored the paladin's travel arrangements with no further tie-ins... seemingly. But fessed up that he was contacted by 'someone' from Illithie to sponsor them for his 'civic duty' and so 'dreams would come true' and 'his sister would disappear' Signed by 'TM' . His sister is alive in the capital, he just wished she were dead. Farquart... fears me, rest of the party know nothing Faeish

Rupert was interrogated afterwards and has received messages from The Man, asking about Farquart's dealing with Illithie and the business, some about joining the household. Took us to an office to see about comparing handwriting between his letters and the one Farquart received from 'TM' and one they got from 'The Man's' henchmen after the ball. Handwriting was a high probability of a match.

Went to ask the accountant about Farquart sponsoring the Paladins. It's sent to the head paladin Vladamir via bank transfer Vladamir Vladicov. Seems his books were unbalanced with missing funds. Income doesn't match expenditures. Last ordered

Molasses three months ago. Spend 15 gp/month on carrier children. Also o cleaning, cooking, gardening. Farquhar is allergic to lavender. Allegedly.

21/11/24

Chestnut horses, silver ones, one with a star mark in the stables. Hands said there's been some exotic horses including a unicorn. Also been an uptick in random people. And a lady that's rather easy on the eyes, might be lady bligh. Unicorn might have been from Tian, pulling a carriage of all things.

Lee talked to Starry, Lord Farquart's personal horse, apple in hand. Wanted to see his face in the floor, ice water, hooves polished. Sometimes has shinny knights along with him to bask in his glory, colours unknown, one of them taaaal with a shinny, pointy stickl. Met them past the meadow, three gallops away 'that way', North. Shinny people seemed to have ready access to teleporting.

Farquhar had developed a sudden onset lavender allergy recently. Supposedly it happens regularly appears in those who study the occult, according to the cook. Also Farquart's been getting some more guests lately. Hubert the wholesaler is the main point of contact with the household for exotic fruits and swings buy once a month.

Young short cleric in a blue with a bob came to pick up some molasses. Lady bligh was often by for tea and business advice. Rumour her husband was about to leave him.

Gardeners were told to pull all the lavender 13 weeks ago. Put the lavender in a pit 'to' be burned.

12/12/24

Missed a kid telling the party another kid had been kidnapped, headed to the mausoleum where shit was going down. Roachy caught us up, then hands were thrown.

Kid was in the circle, Eangaline and HL Dawn were KO'd One cultist in there had gotten away last time, one of the ones that died called out For Lord Farquart!

Token on paladin's belts seemed to act as keys for the portal, though they summoned a gingerbread bear but it became a friend before vanishing again.

Random mooks appeared but were no bother, were hired by an 'R' to attack anyone they found down here at 10pm, and go to the capital for another reward after.

Hopped through the portal, smelled like the poisons, and a little chestnut. Portal was taking us to a stopgap transit point before we wound up at sword point.

19/12/24

Retcon : I grabbed some armour from a paladin and did the thing.

Swords were pointed at us by haggard people who didn't seem to be Paladins. Illithie regular army, but old and ragged. Just after peace accords. Bert was the point man. Came here three weeks ago, using the circle to get back to the castle. Fought a mage from Rulith, might account for them going wrong. Lillona, the owner of the inn. Company of 30 men. They were dispatched here four months after the war. Some of us have time traveled. Lost their transport tokens from Lord Titus. He's the current Lord Regent of Illithie

Circle here was of an older design but principally the same.

Were in a shabby room, stone lined, old style castle. There's moss, it's been there and unattended for a while. Artificial sugar scent and burning. Land might have been owned by someone called Muffony. Troops seen no people on their way to the Mayor's mansion, whole town had been carpet bombed by a sweet shop.

09/01/25

Guards tried to talk us into taking them through the circle, we didn't want to do so. Things entered into a kerfuffle. Activated the portal after scamming them for a potion of bewitching and 25gp. Lost a boot the process.

Teleported into a place like the original circle, possibly a prison. Graffiti including Illithie will be free, tic-tac-toe, 2-4-16. Seems to be disused as a jail. Rats around. Door's not up to much. Soldiers came with us, sadly. Said they'd thank Titus for us for a favour. If we need something the Eternal Vine monastery will help us via General Mciver. Should be in the middle of Kelsa in the transport halls, but we seem to be in the basement.

Arrived on the 10th day of the month, missed three!

There's an abnormally large amount of conventional weaponry. Priest had monks robes in green. Building did seem to be the Transport Halls of Kilsa. Manager, Bilbo Frankenfurt, brought us to his office and told us a little about the circles, told us the half-truth about how we got there and handed over one of the second tokens acquired. Gave us rooms at the Purple Tulip for a week. Every business seems to be hiring guards as do caravans. Also hidden an Illithie rebelish group poster, code translate to the Green Soldier on the night of the 12th. Location encoded on it, Green Soldier, night of the 12th, password is Eternal Ember. Also a Coffee shop across from the Tulip.

Long Rested inot the 11th.

Poking around for criminal connections put me in contact with Dane, Caravan Escort @ Pink Lotus, Other guards at the Monastery. Someone finally asked Max about their story, got a little out of them.... Went to the pink Lotus, non-diescript place with a small anti-room. Very Floral inside. Discrete booth based room. Asked if we're here for Lord Tom. Giggles and lap dance. Wynona got a lapdance from a busty redhead, Gilbert enjoyed himself for three minutes of a half hour massage...

Escort caravan was to guard dancers on their way to Lord Titus's manor at the capital. Week's trip each way. Needs to be there in a weeks time 50gp each way total. Got contracts for the job to run by the others.

Jorvik found a clause in the contract.

If the girls are harmed in anyway, we take their place in the club. 50gp each way. There and back.

Went to a book store, Wynona found the Very hungry Chimera, Gilbert got How to capture your princes, I found My life as a human being, a dragons observation on

humanoid culture. Gilbert also got an animal handling book. 6-4-5 offer. Also got Suspected origin of circles, Origin of magic species by means of supernatural selection or favoured races in the construction of life. Lost in Translation , Claiming the crown, assassinating royals., 50 shades of drow. How to waste paper (has a spell in it) Chimera, Pet Companion, Dragons as humans, Origin of Circles, Magical species, Waste of Paper

Sky was weirdly dark when we came out. (Time slip) Monastery next, fancy part of town, no messenger kids around. Only humans around town, couple half-elves. Green monk robes.

16/01/25

Tarot Reading.

What paths should we take to discover Lord Farquart's involvement in the conspiracy with The Man?:

Quest: Shield Inverted. Person: Guarded from physical or emotional harm. Situation: Arising from someone selfishly protecting themselves.

That Which is Hidden The Fool, inverted. A con artist presenting a trustworthy facade or something that changes shape to appear harmless...

That Which Is Needed Well, reliable source of information or familiar place of aid.

The Challenge Moon. Concealment and hidden treasures, secret rooms, priceless objects masquerading as worthless

The Outcome The Expert. A source of wisdom and expertise for the situation.

If we can all clear our heads and hold one question in our minds: What paths should we take to discover Lord Farquart's involvement with The Man's conspiracy?

And Max reaches down, turns over the first card and:

Our quest is the Shield, inverted. A person walling themselves off from harm, be it physical or emotional to protect themselves, often selfishly. Is it just me or does that sound like Lord Farquart to anyone else?

The Second card

That which is Hidden. Some small revelations for you all about my past here, some things which may hold us back. And it's the Fool, also inverted... I do find it frustrating when the cards are this... accusatory of my history. It... can mean someone who is not as they appear... or...

Third card

What we need for our quest. The well, a place or person we're always found reliable. Either for information or material aid. I don't suppose anyone knows of any old friends or flames in town which we could turn to for assistance?

Fourth Card

Our challenge, ladies, gentlemen and that wonderful technicolour rainbow in-between, is the Moon, representing hidden and secretive endeavours. Secret rooms, objects which appear to be worthless but are actually very valuable. Hiding in plain sight. So we'd best all keep our eyes peeled, and our minds open.

Fifth Card

And our final outcome is the expert. It seems we should be gathering allies against Farquart rather than confronting him directly. Those who know him and his schemes, or who can aid us against him.

Session, post conspiracy board making.

Monastery, Brothers of the Eternal Vine, here to see about another Escort Quest. Approached a guy praying in the chapel. Green robes with silver/blue belt. Father Urvas wants us to protect him against a death threat that he wants to die tonight. Suspected heretics might want to kill him.

Offered us info, pearls and 10 lumps of gold nuggets. Info about the kidnappings and people going missing. Every four days people were getting escorted out of town. Had only told his god about the kidnappings... he's more than he's letting on... As in knows exactly where the children are going.

Suspects they're being taken to a ritual run by the Eternal Ember to bring about the fiery apocalypse. Wants us to escort him to the ruins to find the Ember's 'artifact' they're going to sacrifice the children's souls to to bring about the new age. Actually Father Elrick. Was part of the Church of Velenar.

Might be a master key to the Teleportation circles in the ruins as they were covered in ashes. The untranslated symbol on the circles meant Key, which is the name of the town the ruins were in. He had a token to activate a circle... somewhere.

Decided to head out just now. After grabbing some fire resistance potions. Ash started to be smelt as we got closer and trees thinner and scorched. Got there to and it was a wrecked city, razed to the ground. Even the stone is scorched black and even melted in places. Plaza was dominated by a stone obelisk, cracked but standing. Inscription "Balance the flame to awaken the path." Couple holes in the stone.

Stone tables were around. Earth, air, fire, water, spirit, life. Fire and water tablets worked. Projected a holographic map of the transport circle network before it burned out.

Bedtime stories about the culture that made the city and network. **Insert stories here.** Very fire oriented pyromaniacs...

Transport hub like building in the middle of the city, broken mural holding a fire above their head, scratched out face, being worshiped, "Flame eternal, guardian of the way" Book had "Awakening the embers true purpose" and "Guiding the faithful to the flames origin." Father seemed to suggest the book pointed to the 'Vault'.

Transport hub building's basement was untouched by ash and dust heavy. With some very faint foot steps down here, leading to an ornate door with four firelit braziers around it and an inscription above. "Only the Worthy may hold the balance of power." Next to each flame is an inscription. "Feed me to rise. Douse me to sleep. Stoke me to awaken. Extinguish me to reveal." Got the puzzle open to reveal a scorched pedestal in the middle, map on one side, sculptures on the other.

Piece of paper in modern script said: The artifact is a tool of great creation and devastating destruction. The balance destroyed in the purging flame. Father said the council of four debated about the artifact and hid it away to keep it safe but if one of them blabbed it could have caused conflict.

Map was fragmented with four symbols. Flame in the middle. Tree East, storm cloud south, mountain west. Sacred forest in Rulith with burnt ruins in there Stormhaven is about where the South was on the rose. Mountain pass with an impassible mountain range with a fort built on ruins to the West.

Sculptures show small humans being marched towards a flaming figure with no face. Documenting a ritual that did happen, likely a human with aspirations to god tier. It's holding a cup sized flame. Gilbert Mending the statue and got the face of a chiselled man face with pointed ears. Totally not Gilbert...

31/01/25

Before the area was ruled by the current people the survivors of the area passed down stories of a figure who stepped out of the flames and survived, imagining him immortal and eternal... and average in looks.

Went to the transport hall's main area. Welcome sign was scorched out to just W.C.E. surviving. Room was much the same with desks around, no doors, just an open area with one circle in the back behind some charred desks. Circle was almost twice as large as the others and the only thing not affected by fire., it was directly over the pedestal below. Circle didn't seem much different aside from the size, and it's a bit more looked after and 'old school'. Gilbert walked in and got hit by a psychic barrier that didn't seem to be related to the circle's magic. Seemed to be coming from a crystal hanging from the ceiling, a clear diamond worth 200gp. Gilbert got the diamond down with an unseen servant and it was loaded with a Glyph of Warding, higher level than normal. It seemed to work as a Spell Storing. Father set "Heal Us" as a trigger for Mass Healing 9th.

Rest of the town was crispy, had faceless man murals. Scriptures around talking about the flame marking the true path. Found voices talking about recruiting tomorrow. Someone was demoted for losing the mother, lady dawn.

George, listen to me, punishment, lost the children, his fault they didn't get a dozen from stormhave n. If he'd succeeded he'd be able to pass through the flames but he lost 'her' (child?) and high lady dawn. 48 kids were on the mural... Wynona connected dots with her home near the forest on the map... And we rolled initiative.

Gilbert got some copper off one guy, 5 silver ish from the other... and a note from his mum. "Dear gilbert, times have been tough and you lost gilbert school but her home is open to you. P.S. respond or she's coming to find him." The date was three weeks ago.

Other node: Dear Gilbert, found a gentleman who knows where he is. Pleased don't murder him. Also from his mom a couple days ago..

Note for Max. "Hear you're in town. Meet me at your convenience. D.I."
Hidden date for the 14th Fatemarch.

Magpie Feather for Wynona.

Also a note for Camie "We'll be passing through town and have job for you Love to see you again. Quarkus.."

Hidden note "You are in danger, stay safe, here to help in stormhaven when we can"

Jorvik had a love letter "You don't know who I am but I know who you are. Ill be yours to hold in the night. XOXOXO"

KO'd guy started interrogation about where the letters & feather came from. Was told to take any mail for us for the next wee while by his 'superior' to keep it on him and to leave it at the appropriate time. Father Superior has a giant sword, shinny armour, blue sash. Big guy paladin? Passed the trial of passing through fire. Took a potion of fire resistance. Job was to sow chaos, kidnap children, make sure George did his jobs. We were to leave the letters at one of the cult meeting after we were sniffing around or if we were to come after him Evangaline was given to the Father superior, Dawn escaped from George. Hand off was here. Next location was to the West. Dawn was kept two buildings over.

Doctrine says kids are pure vessels to be moulded into perfect vessels of the ember. Blood will serve as the kindling and bring about the end times, and the eternal flame will come about.

Been to Stormhave, Kilsa, Laconoiois, Lightlast, Fairland, seat of his holiness in Quvard. Quvard offers kids up... Sacrifice is a part of life there. Stopped him from biting down on a poison pill.

Superior tasked them with 'wandering' around the ruins. Had a mask in Kilsa above the Pink Lotus.

Father Elrick shot him, he spotted the fathers face and was surprised before he died. Father checked out the cells where Dawn was. Left the Father to burn the bodies. Went through the pockets, checked out their hands. "Ah yes. The weak do perish, don't they."

Caught up with the others at the burned out cell, melted metal and handcuffs. Dawn had left a symbol of a setting sun with a small plant below, of the God Velenar". carved into a corner of the room. Symbol of message "Meet me at the Yellow Duck".

We headed back to town, the Father was very excited about burning some bodies.

Gilbert went to find his mother. Local said she would stay at the Purple Tulip. Bar keep directed her to our room. Looked like there'd been a fight, a note in the middle: Stop investigating if you want to see your mother alive again.-Dad.

Lettering matched The Man?

Post office. Wynona's feather came via the capital from a town down south. Postie got interrupted. Camie's letter came from Stormhaven via here. Clerk said it wasn't likely to be written by a man. Similar to High Lord Ferox of Covard.

13/02/2025

Uta'h arrived with male to send. Postie confirmed a lot of letters e had matched Lord Ferox's handwriting. Rested for the night back at the tavern. Left a card in the window to signal DI.

Utah went asking about the owner of his traveling circus, Mr Fizzywinkle, but didn't have much luck. Went to the Yellow duck to chedck for High Lady Dawn. More of a local tavern than an adventures one. Spot someone in the far corner in odd lighting Gilbert and Uta'h distracted the room while I went and talked, it was indeed High Lady Dawn. Feared it might be too late for Evangaline and any of the other children.

Stealing Children with each of the attributes, strength, intelligence, cunning, unknown 4th. Plan to steal the high leader's son at the summit to break up the peace. Cultists taunted her, saying it was sanction by Rulith, High Lady Dusk reportedly orchestrating it. Doesn't know if they're outright killing them or just draining them for their attributes. Sacrifice seems to be losing the thing they hold most dear.

She seemed defeated since Stormhaven, and possibly hiding something...Chamie opened her up; High Ladys have word-of-mouthed a myth that the World would be consumed in flame once more. Stormhaven was founded as a safe place after storms washed away previous towns on the edge of the world. Prophecy was probably bible-great-flood territory + warning for next time. Having a crisis of faith right now.

High Lady dusk (according to the cultists) was giving the cultists names to kidnap, supposedly. High Lady Dusk is expected to be in the Alithie capital soon, Dawn could meet her there... Father Elrich might or might not be working for Lady Dusk. Talking Dawn into swapping places with me when we meet with Dusk.

Dawn was staying here under the name Denniese

Went back to the Monastery and met those soldiers from Ginge. They'd caught up that they missed 20 years... Spoken to Lord Titus and agreed to grant us a favour. Meet in the capitol and dro his name, 'General David'. Also gave us 108gp total. , divided by 6 = 18gp.

Swung by a magic shop to get disguises for the meeting. Unusual to have a magic shop in this country. Slightly more sense given the boarder town but still odd. Disguise Self scrolls etc.

20/02/2025

Did the card reading at last. Went to the Green Soldier, old man's club, smoke curling, someone gesturing people to the door. Gilbert finally got in, dressed as the Wicked Orc of the West.

Door lead to a passage way leading to two guys holding a vine and a flower, offering to cleanse them.

Gilbert took both, threw the vine in the flame.

Nathan got a flower

Chamie took a flower

Manny took a vine

Wynonoa took a vine

Max bluffed their way past as a Paladin.

Past the door was a flame, saying Cleanse the Old.

Young folk in late teens-20's were around facing a stage. Everyone else took a fire resistance potion. Guy in a hood appeared to conduct proceedings. Welcomed the Youth to the meeting. Evils from the South, nationalist kind of meeting, with flamy burning away the rot vibes to allow new growth to emerge. Offered the usual nonsense to cast aside the decaying systems. Claimed to be above nature and the balance. Wanted to usher in new world order, after a purifying fire.

"Pure vessels just as children are, ready to be born anew."

Back door burst into flames divine presence controlling the flames, but another one shielded us going through it. First one was warm and burny and angry issues, and the second was the cold sweet kiss of death.

One of the kids had a brother with a contact high up in Covard, talking about things bigger than Illitihi and 'us'. Talked them into becoming a piano player. Meeting coming up. Talked her into opening up, Assistant of the Passion of the Ember, answering to the Flame Shepard (Regional Manager). Found an artifact to ignite a World Clensing Fire. Taking it to a sanctum, the priest has a map (maybe) Trying to destablise illithie by kidnapping influential families and assassinating Titus next week. Lara and Laurance Vane.

Gilbert took 30 bottles of some unknow liquid and a few daggers.

The Kids felt HIS touch alone as they passed through the flames, no touch of Cold.

Couple bouncers took Wynona, Utah, Chamie and Manny into the next room lined with stone and a stone table. Sacrificial alter kind of stone table. Lots of flames. Few guys in armour... And a locked door.

Fight started, power word shit happened, Gilbert got naked...

27/02/2025

Boss DD'd to the other room, went with him. Had to think fast.

Brethren, I bear this sash, a token of Vladamir Vladischov. I have had to infiltrate this organisation to uncover a dastardly conspiracy against this realms. This man is not as he appears and seeks to unravel all that that we have worked towards.

Convinced the rest of the room to turn on the Priest, he tried a God Call to immolate himself... but God wasn't listening. Goons bound and gagged him for me.

Other guys in the first room with the fight wrapped things up, saved Lara the civi they were talking to and sent her away safely... Told her to check in with High Lady Dawn's alias Denniese at the other tavern

Someone also Nat 1'd a giant octopus into existence and Gilbert tamed it...

Talked the rest of the goons out of the room, took the priest back to the others.

Got a map fragment with faded annotations and symbols along its border: Three concentric circles with burnt vines under them and flames dotted about. Seemed to line up with some transport circles somewhere, flame sigils lined up with settlements in illitih and covard. Map was fire resistant.

Invisible ink revealed:

Father aldrin watches but cannot act, the vine reaches deepl. Roots burn next moon.

Coordinates to just outside the transport circle for the capitol, abandoned vineyard.

Plain text

Ashes mark the path, the ember heart sleeps beneath the bones of the past.

The vine shall burn where the flame first kindled. Seek the sunken sanctum.

One symbol with a triple flame at the mountain fortress in Tian

Red X's seemed to be supply lines, crescent flame about a few cities.

Symbols on the altar had burns vines and flame sigils but noting of particular note.

Interrogation revealed the name 'Emberheart' to be the one people sacrificed to.

Gave us the spiel about how the cult was to dismantle all the old social orders.

The kids were 'recruited' to the Emberheart.

Plans to kill or kidnap Greenway's child and kill Titus at the summit

'The Man' is one High Arms working in Rulif, might or might not be a 'her'. They seek to begin the ritual to bring 'Gilbert' back to life.

Lord Ferox isn't a lord of Covard, is just one half, Lord Kedric is the other half who has a son that was stolen as a baby. Lord Ferox together? The two split?

Gets to Kovard via a portal town then boat.

Eternal Ember has at least 300 members in this priest's branch.

Halric Dane, advisor to lord Titus who wishes to fill Titus' boots.

Divine Sight Seers are maidens blessed with Emberheats sight who can see prophetic visions from the sanctum, slowly their eyes are burned out though.

Father in Velinar's church works with them who has caused a whole heap of chaos.

Recently burnt some bodies.

Relasie has been undermining guild leaders and harassing caravans between countries.

Four heads of the religion, from there the cult divides into four.

The cult stole Gilbert's mother and took her to the hideout on the old vineyard near the capital

06/03/2025

Killed the priest, got teh octopus to a bath, traumatise the pianist, check in with Dawn.
Had a vision.

Standing in a twilight field, half in sun half in darkness. Four silhouettes fading into one another like ink in water'

Small flame at feet, impossibly small casting shadows to the horizon. When she reached for it it spread into four. One to the South where it flickered out. One went to the West and flickered uncontrollably. North ignited symbols of burning scriptures. One went East causing the ground to crack open and reveal ruins beneath the soil.

A vision of ashes ... flickering ember refused to die. A flickering figure cloaked in shadow and flame in a transport circle. Two doors opened to burning light and crushing darkness. Figure reached for both

Dawn heard a voice, possibly Velenar, "Paths diverge, flames flicker."

We're expecting visions of our own in time...

Dawn's hired mercs from the Guild in Tyan before, including Rellis, but they've not been taking contracts for a while.

Ferox is a high priest of Covard, and a whiny bitch. Now an isolationist.

Father Aldrin and Dawn came up under the same High Lady, became a roving scholar searching truth and facts. Was supposed to be sequestered in a remote monastery for a yea in the Northern Peninsula.

Mystery shots happened... Had a nap and were transported Elsewhere in a vision....

Chamie went back to the Artisans and walked to a field of silver grass

Max was back with their Dance Instructor before they found their way to the fields of grass and the sky was split into day and night.

Gilbert was back at bard school and seen a sun and moon hanging opposite each other.

Jorvick Jorvicked and the sky was split into day and night

Utah was in the circus before he wound up in the fieldm, air was still and distant as if under water.

We became aware of each other and a tree of bark was ahead of us, half lively and half burned embers

At the base was a stone circle of shifting ruins with four tokens with a crest for each nation. Wolf Rulith, Blade kovard, golden spiral black flame for Tyan, lit up the circle and split the ground.

Sky darkened, ash and fire swallowed the land, not-gilbert stepped out of the flame, holding an ember with warmth, and a withered vine.

Ground shattered and we plunged into a void. One ancient eye opened, we felt power and balance.

Resonant voice hit us. Balance frays, flames hunger, vines strangle, choose the path, seek the ember beneath the stone, truth beneath the vine, Smell of smoke and earth woke us.

Ruins matched the older style teleport network

Detect thoughts revealed about the hooded figure: Represented a choice which he can recreate. Either hold an ember or a vine. Doing one provides a benefit, doing the other a different one. Refusing both is no-action. Closing hand one one makes the other prevail.

Chamie drew the tree and some other things for the dream, it grew cold in the room, the tree outside mirrored it. "Roots dig deep. Seek the something beneath Ash and Stone" Got a flash. The Cult is planning to murder Titus and sacrifice Greenway's kid.

Gilbert straight away went to do this... He chose the flame. Advantage on insight vs deception. Fire flickered around him... And a bunch of people started paying attention to him. Thoughts in the area turned to him...

They were panicking and several seemed to have been at the meeting earlier...

Vladimir Vladischoy and entourage walked in, drawn by what Gilbert did. Pointed Gilbert's mind reading at him: My persona, the paladin, was reported KIA.

Gilbert warned the others and they filed out a window... Along with Dawn, Calamari and the piano girl. I'm alone with Vlad.

13/03/2025

—

Kovardian poison was in our coffee in the morning. Someone seemed to have abducted the inkeepers wife.

20/03/2025

Left the Pink Lotus and ran into Cyrena outside, wanted our help protecting her Druidic circle from Hill Giants. Caught her up on all the nonsense and headed to the library in the nice part of town.

10 stories tall, two towers with a glass bridge between. Lots of fancy scholars. Much as expected within. Complete with a helpdesk.

Utah asked after Fizzywinkle: He was last seen in the Wealth district of Laconius, the capital, census is two years old. Cyrena looked up some giant lore. Gilbert got a book about the High Priests of Quvard. I asked after transport circles, Pippa (absent) got stuff about the ruins.

Collected Myths and legends of the known realms, Scholar SOMETHING of the Ivory Spire.

Myths of our world hold time distorted truths.

Pyre's Breath

Vath' oral tradition

Flame was born, ancient star buried deep. Touching it got visions of distant lands. Cult believers it to be the heart of the Ember heart, imprisoned. Scholar found scorched stones somewhere that seemed to back it up, though people chasing it also came to ruin.

Silent Watcher

Quvardiqan merchant lore

Merchants crossing northern mountain path, stone warrior cursed to watch the world he sought to rule. Gaze shifts with the seasons, maybe treasure. Tied to pre-ancient race civilisation, ruins at its base tied with the transport circle. Vath'iran civilisation. Not sure where it's from.

Mother's Tithe

Church of Velinar Cannon

Mother pleaded with Velnar to spare her child, burned her crops, child recovered but the mother was cursed to hear of her crops in the wind. Similarities to the Ember's cults belief. Ties into Whispers in the wind, Whispers in the Ashen Hall

River's Chain

Tyan Mt. Lore

Hearders speak of a hidden river binding the earth itself with invisible current but a real pull. If the river's course is broken the river's bones will shatter. Fortress ruins show waterways with element transport glyphs. Leylines or conduits.

Cradle of the Forgotten

Stormhaven Dockside

Island appears during storms, spire of rock. Prison for a monstrous entity stealing warmth from hearths. Blackened iron seems to be a link to the Sunken Sanctum.

Sunken sanctum lies beneath stormhaven, half eroded up top but the foundations solid. Set up by the Ember Wardens imprisoning Emberheart, a fiery being of wrath and renewal immolating regions to purge weakness. Wardens wanted to imprison it. Sanctum has an inner chamber, flood mechanism and seal of four flames. Cult wanted to break it free and breached the outer wards but breaking the last seal broke Heart out of control. Wardens flooded the ruins and slowed things down. Seems the waters are warmer and ashier than usual around here.

Handwriting in the margin matched Father Elrick.

Located near Stormhaven, folklore heavy influence. Originally a place of worship between destruction and renewal. Wardens maintained it, revered Emberheart's duality. Contained it to keep it contained...

Cult's forerunners believed it was a god to purify the ward. War of the Ember nearly wiped everything out to reshape the world in fire. Wardens turned a temple into a prison, flooded it with water. Wardens sealed themselves and gave their lives to seal it.

Drowned veil on the lower levels, dark liquid moves erratically with lights in it. Spirits of the Wardens haunt it, Emberheart may have corrupted them.

Cult views it as the Heart's throne. Want to drain the chambers so he can consume the continent. Might already have a way to weaken the wards. Ancient symbols have been appearing on the walls.

Elrick seemed to be going to put a stop to it...

Floral Myths and legends

Vines and flowers are a sign of power, sacrifice and renewal.

Vine that hung the world

Quavardian sailor's tale.

Vast vine winds through the core of the world, woven from forgotten kings and queens. If the vine is severed, world is cast adrift and dead will rise to recover it. Might be stand in for Leylines or magic conduits.

Garden of tears

Thorned Crown

Whispering Tears

Bloom of First light

Whispering Hands

Folklegend from stormhaven

Parasitic vine Grave Grass, coils through forgotten tombs feeding on memories. Wind calls out to travelers promising secrets. Vines overwhelm their minds.

Actually seems to be brewed into a mind enhancing elixir that enhances the mind, but eventually breaks it.

—

Portal Lore, Gilbert pinched it. Then ran through a portal with Utah

27/03/2025

Between the Book and Backstory, figured things out. Gilbert used the old token on the old circle following the leylines. Intent matters when using them correctly and effects the destination.

Bilbo's desk: Poison, tokens, letters, 51 sp, ruby, crystal ball, stationary, more letters uhnder drawer, blue sash

17/04/2025

Vlad's pockets had flame teleport tokens, 2gp, fragment of a map.

Room had ruby encrusted plate, jade cup with a flawless blue diamond.

There seemed to be a lot of wine here, before it was shipped off to the peace summit.... And probably poisoned by a new Quavardian position we've not encountered before. Similar to Midnight Tears.

Found a cupboard full of blue sashes, and a continual flame orb again.

08/05/2025

Vlad's creed involves cleansing the world in truth and fire. Thinks the souls of corrupted and rotten settlements need to be cleansed.

Gilbert's mother came to the cult looking for him, they tested her with the orbs and her eyes didn't burn out when she scryed.

Three people showed up and claimed to be his mum. Vlad thinks an upstart god sent them? Also convinced Gilbert's mum is Ferox's child... Also some Back to the Future nonsense.

Jorvik somehow knew that this was mostly bullshit about the time travel, but he believes Gilbert's Mum and Ferox got together.

Sacrificing a divinely marked child (Gilbert) will increase Ember heart's power threefold.

Feels Ferox is a good leader and Kovard's mouthpiece for their diety: Virelya, aka dyonisis. Ferox is also in the Cult, high up in it.

AFAVladKnows the Cult has Ferox as high priest, The Man as the head of the spy network of the whole cult. There's a third person, also works in the shadows, The Flamekeeper

The Man was at the ball to steal the necklace of Greenway, which protects her, and when they kill her it'll bring a piece of the Feywild to the world? The Sundering 2.0. I'm not drunk enough for this...

Kids are chosen for particular reason: Lineage, smarts, visions of gods, etc.

Sacrificing 'legacies' to the Emberheart. Emberheart tells the cult and marks them specifically via Oracle visions.

Oracles are at Ashenhold, major cult HQ. Old vaults under there where the first flames flickered. About 100 cultists and 20 prisoners, not all of them still corporeal.

Plans at the peace summit are to kill the idea of peace, sow chaos, break alliances and cause war. Prey on the carnage.

Emberhand are the paladins, 12 total, 7 operating, the rest hidden in temples and the like.

Got through to the 'Emberheart'

Been ages since he walked free and was locked up. Wants out. The Faithful will bring him forwards. Think they'll be rewarded, but not all will be.

Emberheat hung up. The Verdant pyre is a node, a shrine, caught between nature and fire. Want to weaken its chains in the nodes and thus let Emberheart break out of the Sunken Sanctum. Seems we broke a chain by accident at the burned city.

Also we're all Divine Touched. Also also at least one of the other gods are imprisoned.
L Also also also we killed Vlad.

Buried Vlad, broke camp, and started off to the City on the carriage. Lady Dawn gathered us around for story time: TL:DR Once in a blue moon a god will give a child the essence of themselves, a trait, be blessed to cause chaos or prosperity, etc. Often go on to have many adventures.

Might be Valathan gods (the old civilisation) who are still imprisoned. Dawn thinks the Emberheart might not be a GOD, just a high enough power it doesn't matter. Also Velinar sounds like the voice we had in the dream vision. Velinar's Scripture suggests Velinra suggested earlier than other gods. The others came into being as aspects of Velinar as mortals' collective consciousness expanded and new ideas needed a form.

15/05/25

Story Time. Gilbert and Cyrena are related!

22/05/2025

Arrived at the Capital, Laconius. Dual one way system in and out. Approaching from the East. Seemed to be checking people against flyers in the queue. Standard airport security. We faked our way through by pretending to be taking a giant pumpkin to a contest. Guard was called Arvinter, or something.

Five districts, Cardinal Compass and Central District. Not allowed there without work because Peace Summit.

Crowd is very mixed, we're not in the nice part of town. Posters calling for Unity are vandalised. Talk of missing people as we pass by. Church of Velinar looking robes, among other religions.

SE

Alaric Voss, Magistrate Central District. Very Stressed. Permit for selling booze, maybe.

Busted Halberd, tavern, Niconbery, Spies and off duty guards. Zellin Farro, owner of Hallow Hearth, nosy gossip.

Honi, Graveyard of St Immurel, whispering and soul eating spirits. Also Docks on the riverside. Warehouse Row is mostly abandoned, some minor activity with blue sashes. Salt Tooth docks controlled by merchant factions. Greymender's in charge of them. Knows about Missing Children.

SW

Districts, Reva, Ivy Hall, exotic florist and herbalist. Ask about hiding the scent of lavender in a Censor for the Cult of Eternal Vine to bless the opening of the Peace Summit so we can smoke out Quavarian Poisoners... also ask about Quavardian Poisoners.

Temple to Velinar and aspects, dusk dawn mid and night in Corat. Temple only still standing because of previous Peace Treaty. Surprising to still be here it seems.

Printer has a Watchtower overlooking ruins, used for scouting and keeping an eye out for dragons.

NE

Espr Quarter, Forgotten Archive, partially condemned library, Maidra's fave 'haunt', old scholar.

Sunmore, abandoned amphitheatre used for protest and the like. Heavily guarded. Flame grafitti gone up there, lately. Caused a fuss at the historical site.

Pharig has a military outpost, heavy recruitment atm, also a prison. Primary rally point for attacks. Slums around the corner. Three colours of badge/sash to identify guard/paladin... like the kidnapped kid's out-of-body experience.

Greathook is the slums.

NW

Kashe, statue of Illithie the Bright, monument, Philos Tren gives speeches there. Sculptor, artists of the peace statue, native Illithian, very Patriotic. Tren might be touched by Vellinar. Check out Murals...

Dwulcliff Market Street, winding street, Magical Wears, Relics, heavy guard and spy presence. Issues with counterfeit products.

Tour Guide Cobolt introduced us to Rexus, gold dragonborn, for some jobs. Grave Robbings, Honi, Priestess investigating. Church by graveyard. White Swan Coffee shop, scholar, Farrier, Ust End, missing a stablehand after meeting a client. Docks, shipment gone missing for the peace summit. Guards want to find it. Great Hook, Rex has a guy, seen children being loaded into a wagon. Statue's been 'crying' in the Red district through the night. Molten Tears. Peace keeper and historical figure rumored to be sabotaging ceremonies in Kashe. Political symbol of their house. Negotiated the Peace Treaty.

29/05/2025

Rumours to track

Down in the Docks – Docks, Honi • The docks are rife with unrest. A shipment marked for the peace summit has gone missing and the dockworkers are being accused. The guards are looking for a neutral party to be involved

Slum Shadows – Slums, Great Hook • Someone has information about children being loaded into a hidden wagon weeks ago and in exchange for more information, has a small favour they need settled

The Monument Murmur – A Statue, Red • Whispers say the old statue of a healer has been “crying” molten tears during the night and city officials are ignoring it

Crooked End – District Boarders, Pharigg/Great Hook • A child has gone missing, and the guards are looking for someone to track down the child

The Hollow Hearth – The Hollow Hearth, Niconbury • There’s rumors of a drunk who talks about a head paladin in blue

Stalewatch – Guardhouse, Thinelshade • A guard was found dead near the wall and they are looking to hire someone to investigate as they are short staffed due to the summit

Saltcoil Wharf – The Docks, Honi • Crates marked with strange flame sigils have been seen unloaded at night

Elaric Voss is in a panic as diplomatic courier carrying documents for the peace summit is missing, and the summit’s legitimacy depends on the documents they carry
Filos Tren is rumoured to have strange visions since he recently restored a statue as is said to be “touched by Vel’enar”

Drask Tellen recently treated a patient whose burns never healed and whose mutterings mention “the Ashenhold”

Maedra Lurith needs help getting past some political red tape and minor wards to retrieve a forbidden tome on ancient transport circles

Mirava is looking for someone to investigate the strange ash-like residue in the recent coffee shipments

Zellin “Five-Pints” Farro is a gossip and for the right price, might be able to tell you some interesting information

Graye “Salttooth” Mender’s nephew is missing, and he last worked as a dockhand

Reeva of the Ivyhall is looking for someone to gather strange flowers that only grow in the cursed ruins outside the city, and tells myths of flowered vines that spring up after sacrifices

Night time arrival antics

Gilbert looked for scholarly stuff related to the cult. M person at the library wants books on transport circles from Vath'irian civ and needs body guards for it. Wards and traps in the Tower of Names around the corner from the library. Tower sealed by local authority.

Peace summit: Wing of the manor was sealed off for some reason, Maera thinks they're putting a transport circle in there. Might just be conspiracy theory, one Transport circle to rule them all. Buried circles undertowers sealed off. Gilbert offered an old transport token he pinched off of me.

Rumour that one nation is going to walk out on the summit, tyan or maybe qavaud Someone tried to bribe the city steward to get into summit with a forged invitation, spy stuff.

Foreign clerics have been whispering about divine cleansing. Counter cleansing them might pay.

Ferox has recently arrived and taken up an inn in Yonberry. The Merry Elf.

Maedra, scholar, aging backwards in presence of ancient transport token.

Also she's an archfey of the unseele.

05/06/2025

Cobalt joined us, not getting extra pay.

Magic door in the basement, Maedra can't get in. Pillared entrance, lots of big glass windows.

Entering, it's all dusty inside with abandoned book cases, cracked door at the back, possibly stairs. Gilbert went blind...

Spotted some kind of Fey glamour, and a trip wire of black cold iron.

Downstairs was a chandelier with magic lightbulb flames. Circle of fire and thorns etched into the door.

Recesses in the walls that might 'pop out'. Pushed to reveal bronze robes hovering in the air...

Fire, thorn and circle glyph carved above the door. Hanna found the glyphs have a companion elsewhere in the building.

Symbol on the door was a Ward with Divine and Elemental magics.

Gilbert touched a robe and caused us to roll Initiative. Got them delt with. Cyrena put on a robe... One lever of exhaustion until the robe is off. Yeah it's cursed. Whisper in her head "I don't think you know what life really is. Maybe I should add to your burden."

12/06/25

Wynona joined us, and easily spotted the glamour upstairs. Met us coming up and split up to check everything individually. Managed to see through the Glamour this time. Little mechanical creatures around, also some rainbows. Manny grabbed one, it was a little lamp with glasses and a hat. (Tiny Servant) Lin Lampwell Miranda.

Front Left, Lee's room, empty book cases and wobbly chairs. Illusioned still. Broke one by sitting on it.

Middle Left, Fiona. No traps. Floor to ceiling books, tables, general knowledge books. Found the Very Very Hungry Chimmera's Birthday Party. Symbol on the window frame... she decided to pry it out. Managed to cleave it out. As she moved it from the moonlight it started to glow less. Looked like a carved flame when out of the moonlight... turned to the glyph of ice when in moonlight... Utah short rested and ice breathed it. Icing spread up and, presumably down below the floor.

Middle middle left had books and cabinets with skulls and such in jars. Poison bomb under a loose floorboard. Disarmed it, found 83gp and a potion of invulnerability... Also got the bomb out. (4d6 poison)

Back left, Chamie, got a lamp companion. Also learned how to forge Fey Masterpiece artworks. Scenes changed as you observed them like holographic lunchboxes. Including unicorns frolics/stabbing people and bleeding treebark. Mountain climbing scene turned into a volcano exploding. Lion eating a gazelle turned to a cat eating a toy mouse. Hannah found some silver behind the paintings and a manual of bodily health. Chair in the office felt ominous... no idea why. Aside from the Desk being a mimic. Hannah joined her. And Wynona. Utah's elbow finished it.

Front Right, Nathan, illusion still up, musty tables and mouldy papers. Started flipping tables. Finally seen through the illusion, had wrecked a beautiful room of furniture. Lamps were crying at him. Rolled initiative as a sword came at him. Won, then went to join the mimic fight.

Nathan later came away with four magic swords hanging on a wall.

Middle right, me, no traps, mostly. Three lamps servants looking at books. Mostly just focused on reading. Books on religion, Rulith pantheon, Elvish, Greek, etc. Got whacked by a book while trying to read on a nat 1.

The door to the other room explodes in my face. Still got the door handle... it's a nice door handle. Statue inside was of a rose with thorns. Bronze verdigris vine with a ruby carved into a rose shape. Glyph for blood on its 11 thorns. Dabbed Gilbert's lossful

blood from his wound onto each of them, it started to weep blood from the rose head and the thorns shon... Chased Gilbert out the room to stop fireballs happening. Chamie checked it out and tested the blood, it's Fey. (Check books in locked cases!

Back Right, Hannah, black iron trap on the door. Disarmed another trap inside, not the second... Fireball went off from a Nat 1. Got the fire under control. There was a velvet covered room, couple lamps making out in there. Another one had a desk with a blank notebook, one with booklets about porn of their neighbour. Locked drawer had 15 sp, and a folding boat.

End room had tables with books reading themselves... and a draft. Also sex magic books... Lee grabbed one at random. Found a hole through a corner junction... Gilbert punched through it and found some grooves. There's a glyph of a circle in there with Pact in it... Gilbert and Cyrena said "Family." and sealed a pact.

Maedra seemed to know that the symbols were on a statue, window frame and in a vent... Still hadn't been here. Called Gilbert Gaybert. Told us not to burn the wood glyph... As I was kneeling on him for Reasons. Socks stayed on.

10/07/25

Left the Florist to go to the Honi Graveyard in search of the priest having issues and maybe some Gravegrasp. Gilbert's face was on one of the posters, but with a horrible nose. Also Utah with big ears, Cerena with bug eyes. And Max's blonde bossy lady with a bad bob. Wynona has wolf ears, human face and a rabbit. Chamie and Manny are a single glowing mannequin. Calamari is tiny and Jorvik is just hair everywhere.

Gilbert also got our portraits done for some reason....

Graveyard had a big building covered in Ivy and seemed to be dedicated to the Eternal Vine. Nuns were tending vines and three old men supervising. Some other old woman was squishing grapes with her fingers. She was squeezing grapes as penance for reaching outside her station.

Small graveyard on the edge of the district has had some grave robberies. Ancestral multi-generation graves. Bury, cremate, re-bury, make space. Families of pre-Allithie invasion. Families leave offerings of money, jewels, good wine. Someone's been pinching them. Also some blood sacrifice... Dead birds and blood everywhere. Mother Strisand suspects it's Demon cult hazing or similar. The Mother was sold to the monastery, willing to work for our tavern if we can get her contract.

Fathers are adamant there's no issues with the graves. Barbra Strisand puts the fear of the Vine up the novices... and might be an Archfey again. Caught up with Cerena at a door to the prayer room and an office. Books, vines, office, calendar, harvest times on paper, planting, agricultural ritual stuff.

In a corner behind ivy leaves is a locked cupboard. Inside was stacks of employment contracts.

Also info on comms between Ophius (Father of the Vine here locally) and another father (Hamlet) in another city discussing how their influence is waning because Halric is pushing for militant industrialism. Leaving traditional teachings. Note of fear in them that Halric's not in Allithie's interests.

Halric is an advisor to Titus.

A bloody knife and some maps of graves was also in the safe. Map was of talking stones set to go off at midnight and 1am. Stones in the safe also, two of them.

We took everything and left a cult of the flame doodle on a piece of paper in the safe.

Desk had a gilded letter praising Ophous for his work in Laconius elevating the savages of the docks...

Arranged for Strisand to take the nuns and bust out at night and go to the old abandoned vineyard out of town we arrived at. Note to self, dress as a cultist and make the theft look good.

Graveyard was a little run down, ivy everywhere, well maintained overall. Tombstones had an offering bowl. Utah and I pressed our ears to a vine and heard inviting whispers... and some psychic damage. Utah ripped two vines out and too poison damage. And more psychic damage. And forgot people on the edge of his memory.

Nat 1 got me a card from the deck of fate Investigation, perception, insight on uncovering secrets.

Others spotted a flower out the corner of their eye. Utah grabbed a flower and it became visible to everyone. He and Cerenea cut down a few more vines. Had about seven total and three stand alone flowers.

Check out the graves and the map for what's been sacrifice. Map pointed to more talking stones set to go off at midnight and 4 am.

24/07/2025

Wynona rejoined us... with a spring in her step after leaving with Reeve. Investigating the defaced graves found us some kind of connection between them. Mostly the oldest ones, they seem to be Vath'iran. Ancient civilization that might have built the transit circles. The rituals seem to be 'real' in a religious sense and might or might not be Vath'iran. But it could be... Might be able to find an expert eventually.

On the way to the white swan things seemed festive but there was an under current. Trios of people chatted in the shadows before splitting. Mix of classes. None responded to thieves can't. Passed a busker. Found the Swan. People outside at tables. Fancy glass coffee shop vibes. Half-orc server and Tiefling barista. Clearly in love. Slam poets everywhere. Gilbert's mum was chatting to Chivaun... looked freshly fucked by a barista

It looked to actually be her. His mum was captured by the cult. Eyes didn't go blind when she tried scrying so they kept her. Tried to distract the cult with belly dancing. Life in Tyan's been shit, guilds have been quarreling over running the country. Voltron Deephelm is coming for the Summit. When she left people were overstepping guild sanctions. Left right after Gilbert did.

Gilbert asked his mother about sleeping around with high ranking individuals ... she got around. Love triangle with another woman... and her wife. Prince from Illithie with the Elvis hips. Not 'sampled' Quvardian's for sure. One night with gags and pecs and diamond stud nipples... and other things and an older man at her home. One time she was the bed that others fucked on top of. Bear, redhead twink, big titted woman.

Gilbert's dad might be the 'Quvardian' human with the diamond piercings. Or the halfling triplets, one was in a cuck chair, she was the entertainment on the stag. Elf with mad rope skills was an option. Barbaria human that didn't speak much. Maybe a barbarian.

His mum was met by shape shifting 'humans' (Changlings) that kidnapped her because Gilbert had 'gotten into some things'. She seduced checked the shifters to her side. Some spell enchanted them to speak together. Also she's not been fucked by a god in a very long time, possibly Thalana, the Veild Dreame appeared in a dream that got real.

She's also fucked Maedra... and 'meeting' with Shiobhan. Also due to the entertainers from Kilsa being delayed, Gilbert's mum was the entertainment at the after-summit sex party. Diplomats and attendees needing 'relief'. Possibly Lord Ferox. Cyrena requested Gilbert's Mum seduce Lord Ferox.

Wizard wasn't here, was doing warding. Chivaun and Utah got chat/flirting. Siobhan sent a Gnome to fetch Bilbo, our 'dragon' expert. Utah got whisked to Shiobhan's place. Fancy tasty castle lair. Shiobhan fucked him into a coma.

Reeva arrived and started putting the moves on Wynona.

Store got the beans sourced from a dealer in Tyan.

31/07/2025

Bard was playing in the corner with an expensive red lute. Seemed to be a ritual to awaken a sleeper agent of some kind... Veiled in finery. Red-amber broaches, flufffiest hat. Told Gilbert's mum it was just an old tale of warning. Lee touched the lute and was haunted by his mentor's ghost. Also a lot of psychic damage.

Song was a warning, chorus references transport circle's (The wheels) and the resurrection of t

> 🌍 _Verse 1_

- > In fields where night-lilies dare not bloom,
- > And roots curl 'neath the ash-blown tomb,
- > There danced a child with fire for breath,
- > Who laughed at chains and whispered death.

> 🌙 _Verse 2_

- > A cradle lies in forest deep,
- > Where silence sings and branches weep.
- > The oldest oath, now cracked and worn,
- > Shall bleed again when flame is born.

> 🌞 _Chorus_

- > So spin, O wheel, of fire and vine,
- > The ancient heart beats down the line.
- > When circles blaze and smoke is crowned,
- > The soul once lost shall rise unbound.

> 🌙 _Verse 3_

- > Three masks walk where none should tread,
- > One walks for gold, one walks for dread,
- > The third walks on with guilt in hand—
- > The ash-child knows and makes its stand.

> 🌍 _Verse 4_

- > A pyre lit in garden grand,
- > With hollow kings on borrowed land.
- > The blood of kin, the laugh of flame,
- > The stone remembers all their names.

> 🌞 _Final Chorus_

- > So drink and dance, ye noble fools,
- > While servants sharpen sacred tools.
- > The blaze is near, the spark's been fed—

> The heart once cracked will burn instead.
he embeheart.

Pippa came through! The song shares lines with the tale of a noble betray during the ashen uprising. Song's been chopped and changed with the one in the file. Stone remembers all their names refers to a memorial in Honi that was defaced decades ago.

Ashen Uprising might have been the fire in the city the old woman mentioned a century ago. Started in Central Illithy but spread to Quvard and Rulith. Food riots in Illithie and spread when the nobels started hoarding food, healing and magic circles.

Proto Fire Cult started doing blood and fire magic to 'awaken the flame'. Fires spread until Sunomre was razed. Noble lines were purified for fire. F+Dwulclif Market's TP Circle opened for three days and brought SOMMETHING through Ballad of the burning crown was recorded in a censored quvaridan intel file. Pyre and Flameborn align with the cults ideology Cradel and ash child reference prophecies about divine vessels and reborn gods. Circles Blaze = Transport Circles being subtly referenced. Bard's voice had magical resonance for illusions or enchantment magic to trigger memories like in repressed sleepers. Performance is 100% a ritual component to activate on a city-wide scale.

Bard goes to a hooded figure in the shadows, passes paper to and gets gold. Probably. Then took Gilbert's mum upstairs.

Last time an elderly woman nearby heard it she was a lot younger and the city was on fire. Lots of tension, fire, stones opening. All before the war, a century ago.

Staff had had coffee beans with ashy residue on the beans. Couldn't wash it off. Did poison damage.

Beans came from Tyan on the coast, perfect weather for growing them. Magically controlled climate. Ship from the coast to the Tyan capital where they're dried for transport. Around the coast, up to a port then up to the local docks. Sent to a dragonborn roaster, Shiobhan...

Talking stone was behind the bar... Started at Utah the moment it seen him. Seemed to go off once an hour. MIGHT have been left by a priest.

Headed for the pre-summit celebration. Party atmosphere at the red pavillion. Fountains had wine. Peace and anonymous vibes. People partying in masks. High Lady Dawn is making small talk. At the backc is a fancy table likely for the leaders. Bard on the stage. Couples in corners 'chatting'.

Greenways were delighted to see Dawn.

Greenways at the high table, wives, Lord Titus, Ferox and Voltrin, Lady Dusk

I stuck to Dawn like glue. She and Dusk made small talk about the kidnapped kids and the peace talks. There seemed to be some rivalry between them. Dawn filled them in on the Paladin kidnappings. Dusk had been to the gardens before. Lots of stuff about balance and branches.

Dusk was always wanting to be in the Church from a young age. The pair came up through the Church at the same time. There were FEELINGS but not in a Gilbert way.

Dusk had neutral feelings on Farquart.

Dawn sowed seeds of risk of discord with Dusk.

Dusk's being evasive about whether or not she wants war. Dawn tried to talk her out of it.

Utah planted a zero-dark-thirty screaming stone on Dusk.

Dusk claimed to be worried about the kidnappings still.

Fed Dusk information that Vlad was feeding us intel about the cult in an effort to test her trustworthiness.

Others went to chat to Titus and got side-tricked by bodyguards. Some of the higher-ups recognised them. Including the Greenways.

Seems Dusk has been taking on Dawn's roles, some of them. No other kidnappings have happened but Evangaline's still missing.

Meeting tomorrow morning with the Greenways to discuss kidnappings. And Farquart's sister.

Utah 'spilled' something on Ferox but it was blocked by an aid to test for poison.

5k for Gilbert and the Bad Eggs... if they don't fuck up the performance.

They didn't fuck it up. Greenways liked it. Dusk was surprised at the instruments. Ferox wasn't dad-proud but re-assessed the party in a different light. Crowd surfing didn't go well. Titus was impressed. Wasn't impressed with Wynona until she put his arm through the table. Utah managed to spill some wine on Ferox. Returned to Dawn, Dusk and Max. Dusk went off to apparently go on an engagement with Titus. S

07/08/2025

Seems Gilbert got his pockets picket. Utah and Wynona tacked the thieves, and they both dropped 10 coin pouches. Each. One was sincere in needing to fleece someone for feeding their family... the other was a hardened criminal. Utah got the sincere kid,

Wynona got the hardened criminal. Got our diamonds back. Utah pinched 230gp but gave it to the kid.

Utah evesdropped in some ambassadors with Lord Ferox and whom he was talking to. Ambassadors were waffling about Peace and philosophical. Dusk said about Vleinar teaching about passing through shadow before they reach Dawn. It's strange how many ancient truths were buried in ash, or it's a gift waiting to be uncovered. Ferox mentioned sacrificing one lamb to save the flock, or many children to save the world. Greenway boy was such a bright spark, be a shame if it was snuffed too soon. (He's rumoured to be kidnapped/assassinated)

Ferox was stationed here before the incident with the burned archive. Pieces of information may have slipped. It's also odd that he's at a PEACE summit and might be here to tie up loose ends. There's evidence Ferox's child is missing. Sacralige if he's fucking Dusk.

This from Dareth Vonn, Quvard ambassador.

Night of Ecstasy involves booze and drugs under a full moon giving visions and primal strength from their god Virelia.

We flagged down a canopy server pushing his goods. Wanted to ask about rumours at the party.

Junior mage is really into the floor.

Merchant's wife seems a bit chatty and up herself.

Lady Vasiria's tipsy and a hella gossip.

Man with the blue sash is moving about, told to keep him fed

Received a wine shipment for the fountains but didn't know where from.

Cyrena and Dawn waltzed around the party with detect poison on, got a ping near where the food staging area just off the party was.

Cyrenna Pulled.

Max slipped into the staging area looking like one of the crew. Herd a bossy voice commanding down there. Lots of wine down here. Wine was sourced from three vineyards nearby. 1221, 1231, 1199 special for when the summit starts. Sent to bring grape juice to Lady Vasira. Illithie envoy.

She was drunk ranting about peasants being invited to places and knowing business. Doesn't believe there's going to be a war, peace will be done. Lower houses of government are pushing through emergency war acts in Illithie. Good wine will be brought out during the final statements.

Tyans merchants and guild masters brought a lot of guards. Maybe to encourage the peace to fail. Suspects Illithie lower houses are paying Tyan guilds to make the peace fail.

Illithie wants peace to succeed... with force.

Merc guilds are suffering in business ever since Relis had a disagreement with Lord Voltrin and guild regs were brought up. Money grubbing whores the lot of them, and her but she's married.

Tarnished in Tyan break the law and can't hold office or vote, often kicked out and just pretended they don't exist. Tarnished existence discourage law breaking but rebellions are fomenting.

14/08/2025

Gilbret started gambling again. Hooked the rest into it... I've no idea who won...

Blackjack table had a merchant's wife at it, Senior Susan. Susan was a lower level person in the summit, her sister was in charge of the family, Senora Susan, Supposedly there's going to be more about the summit than peace. Something to do with trade.

Blue sash paladin is Cmdr Yaravik Dravaine, doing 'security' for the summit in the morning. Was Illithian. Commands 35 protecting Lord Titus, all paladins. 3 have the sash. Paladins of Velinar pretend to copy them, but that was bullshit Also not here to guard Titus, was lying.

Cyrena tried to pinch a pin of a little vine holding his sash up... had a spare one. Also got some gold out of one pocket and two more pins in the other pocket, and more gold.

Guy looking at the floor was inspecting symbols on the ground, there were symbols there... Transport circle symbols, ancient ones... like in ginge. They were inactive, but completing the circle would activate them. Looks like maintenance broke them at some point, but it's repairable. KO'd by elephant, going for a lie down in the Scholar's tower, , Jameson Leadweight.

2 gave lee call even/odd summons aquatic dinner.

17 gave me 12 elephant damage.

Pippa tried to alter the circle to proof it against being used as intended.

Two people were watching us, one looking like serving staff and one as priest of the Eternal; Vine. Priest wandered off, Canopies stayed. I went after. Wound up in the manor upstairs. The priest was talking to two paladins in blue, one of them was Yarvik.

Might have a dilemma. Suspect we're interfering trash that needs burned away. Wants to bait us into the maze.

Priest was Father Opheious, head priest the Eternal Vine's Vinyard.

One of the Paladins paid the priest for his services.

When the priest left the Paladins said it's time to bring forth the flame. Wanted to bring forth ember coals and light them in the garden before heading down the same stairs as the priest.

We are the ember coals.

Going to dress up as Farquart.

Canopy guy went to a priestess, spoke for a bit, then moved to the symbol Chamie messed with.

Hannah nipped downstairs while invisible to inspect the poisoned wine. Great Success. Stashed the keg of poisoned wine under a hedge.

21/08/25

Farquart has a TP Circle under his hour to Yarvik's house-not-his-house, in the communal housing, barracks, not the local ones, the secret ones.

Yarvik's an 'Emberhand' , 'oath bound and flame marked'.

Talked to the Paladins and they went off for the ambush. Priestess going for the symbols was waylaid by Gilbert, Ferox and the canopy boy noticed, got frantic, two assistants went to the symbol.

One of the assistants is The Man. Gilbert intercepted them but they got away in the fight.

Water elemental was summoned. Delt with. Paladin ded, baby paladin turned coat, canopy boy captured. Gilbert's mortal enemy.

Utah got the pants. Paladin's junk was out for the last of the fight.

04/09/2025

Cerena and Wynona we found in the hedge maze where a pair of eyes were.

Greenways are pushing to preserve peace and trade, Ferox wants a foothold for Quvard's religion in other nations. Maybe some trade. Titus/Illithie wants trade for merchants and guilds/ magic military accadames ala magic Spartans. Votran/Tyan wants influence in moving goods and mercs around.

Paladin Barracks are under the Esper Quarter's Town Guards barracks. Aprox. 6 + paladins. Two Emberhands in the town, including Yarvig.

Paladins knew Vlad was missing but not that he was dead.

200 towns guard in the main barracks, 4 in the paladins.

Vlad's Paladin Pin is more intricate than Yarvik's implying a higher Emberhand rank.

Gilbert wandered off inside after the leaders. Guards patrolling. Cyrena went with... Both were wearing Paladin Pins. Apparently Titus vouched for them and they let them past.

Guards think it was the Rulithian's, or the Gods/Octopus... who's been summoning things to take over the world. They've been terrorising people. Human's with them still.

Frankie Beniout and Benny Francious .

Utah, Wynona and I Cheerleader Anime threw me be onto the roof.

As Vlad in a cheerleader uniform. Changed to Max mid-jump.

Magic trap was up there. It did not go well but Wynona caught them. Everyone into the maze to change into uniforms. Swiss Guard. Into the Palace.

Gilbert and Wynona headed to Ferox's room and heard a familiar ish lullaby. Not his mother.

Cyrena and Gilbert got into a scrap after a nut tap

11/09/25

Talked our way into the Rulif rooms easily enough. Lori, Tius and Dane were chillin', Dawn was pondering. Guards were about. Got some emergency healing. 'Tested' for poison.

Poisoned wine was Midnight Tears. Everyone would fall into a coma at midnight.

Filled them i about things. The Man at the ball, was there to steal the necklace to bring the Feywild into the Prime, Sundering 2.0. Also sacrifice them and their son. Farquhar involved in bringing the Paladins into things and kidnaping. And extracting their attributes for the sacrifice later. Bringing back the Emberflame from the Sunken Sancum. Also need an army to assault Ashenhold.

Also we need to check out the Verdant Pyre.

Got plans for the Peace Summit. Ferox, the Man and one other are the heads of the cult. Third is involved with the Paladins. Break the peace, Ashen Uprising. And more.

Greenways sent Dusk to the Church to pray guidance over the summit. .. The Man impersonator was never received by Dawn and the greenways.

Talked the Greenways into having their head of household break the news about the poisoned wine. Also get into the west wing about the circles. Tius knows about the circle. Told us about Maedra working with things that shouldn't be touched or altered, like the circles. Rumours about incidents with stealing time from people. Fed into a wild form of 'interactions'. Fish in the sky, metal birb, non-linear time.

Cult stealing time might be using it to fast forward time around the Sanctum. Might also be why they want the Feywild in the Prime.

Tius seems concerned about the Nat 1 consequences.

Being Divine Touched is a blessing and a curse, adventures and heroes but flipside is the weird shit happening.

Sent a runner to get the scholar studying the rune circles. Jameson Leadweight.

All manner of defensive wards on the West Wing. Walked in there just fine in the guard uniform. Antimagic hit. One large room, meeting hall, round table, pillars along the sides, stained glass. Former ballroom, stage at one end. Tables for nibbles. Mage areas with anti-anti-magic areas. Some guards scrubbing those runes out. Guards are 'intense'.

Spotted some funky wood on the table. Knots in odd shapes. It's been manipulated into forming part of a circle. Waiting on the other 1/8th of the circle/table. Linked to transporting out west. New circle runes.

Stones were found under the stage with runes on them for transportation and protection.

Pillars are fancy and have engravings of birds in flight. Third pillar on the South was hollow. Anti-magic field went about 15 ft below ground, where the elevator went.

18/09/2025

Gilbert found us

Ask Scholar questions:

How the cult are bleeding off time magic from the circles, and how they're directing it

Also possibly Maedra's involvement in that in winding back the clock

Also how much time most people usually lose when using the transport circles (30mins-1day = approx 1,000 miles) vs us (losing days-weeks).

Any further detail on the West Wing circle, how it's likely to be completed, how we can stop it.

Split the West Wing when other guards approached. They wore other uniforms, from Tyan. Guild Merchant's crest and colours. Elite guard with fantasy Tactocool armour. Guild Master's guard, not Voltrin's personal. Mix of humans, half elves, orc, fire genasie, akkora. Representative of Tyan.

Voltrin wants an update and the word of poisoned wine is spreading now.

Chaemie and I went down and got locked in. Couldn't get out. Had a joint.

Utah and Gilbert went for the Entrance, fancy statues and carvings of Illithie history. Magic lanterns, ten guards patrolling... Dunno why.

They went to the kitchen and things happened. Cyrena and her boy toy had been in the basement. Recently.

People have taken the poisoned wine, supposedly Farquart did it?

When Utah and Gilbert got us out of the tube, we were high, then a fireball happened when I inspected the lock with a Nat 1. I am VERY high. Chaemie too. We went for nibbles.

Dead chef came back and had heard primal ancient screaming of people burning alive before they left the white waiting room of the afterlife, and a heartbeat.

Gilbert heard all this and now wants to kill himself in a kinky way to experience the afterlife. Went to Dawn to bring him back BEFORE it happened, but she doesn't want to use the spell because that's her domain and all. Did it once, but went against this once before. It was rather Intense.

WE TAUGHT CHAEMIE HOW TO GET HIGH AND FLY!

Dusk joined us having been at the church praying for guidance. Was game for bringing Gilbert back. So she broke his neck.

Gilbert seen a Satyr with dark brown legs, horns that curled back on themselves and deep green forest eyes. Charms on the horns, crescent moon with thorny vines and a cup overflowing with a red liquid.

“It’s not your time.” He was in the in-between. Seemed to recognise Gilbert. Was born in the revelry of his light and blessed by the instincts that drive him. Instincts for knowledge and fighting? Bound by something, was n’t touched by his divine righteousness but keeps an eye on him, like his father. Father is close but not close, closeness is fickle.

Called them Ilhara. Knows him as they know all their children. Being evasive about the name, need to search for the answer.

Asked what his purpose was. Answer unknown, ask again later. Some want him to embrace the flame and renew himself in their image, others to uphold the balance. Satyr wants to see him revel in his wildness, set himself free, reach past the harshness of his life and see he is free.

Seek them in the wilderness when his primal instinct awakens. Gilbert’s mother fucked this entity’s ‘vessel’ Know who did the divine touching, but didn’t want to say. If we want to find the one who did the touching, seek within. This entity had a vested interest in Gilbert. Not the rest of us.

He’s also not fully dead, this ain’t the afterlife the fireballed civi got.

Perhaps this entity is on par with the Emberheart and there’s some kind of sibling rivalry going on. Because gods are always that fuckin’ petty. Check a library for info on this stuff in DEEP lore.

Gilbert lied about what he seen to Dusk and Dawn. Then filled Dawn in on it fully. Dawn didn’t think it was a Diety from the Velinar pantheon.

25/09/2025

While meditating (while high) on who I could be Divine Touched by, it's for sure one of Caelith, Thalana or Ilhara. Caelith in the end. Right with the first choice. 4/6 people chose to be enlightened too.

Woke up with things moving around us all. That Schollar FINALLY showed up. James Jameson Jamison. Thought the stones Chaemie found might make a new circle out of them, but wasn't sure. Might be ways to alter a circle or form a protective circle. Possibly fill in gaps in the table circle.

Can't alter the table circle, intention is set up when it's made.

When Chamie mentioned she altered a circle, he thought she was Vatherian. Also seemed to know Maedra. Didn't want to know of her. Partially because she's scary, partially she's his ex.

Loosing days is uncommon. Only happens rarely. Seemingly feed a supply of stolen time stored outside of normal time to feed the Vatherian's idea of immortality. Tokens seem to leak time from this reservoir. Like Maedra.

Tokens are contracts? Found mention of debt linked to the tokens. When they're created they bind the users lifeforce to the circle. By holding the token you link your life force to the circle.

Been all over Sunmore, he couldn't find the rune circle.

Rumours that the Fey warned the Vatherians the Circles would disrupt the natural weave of fate... before the Fey destroyed them. Likely the Seelie. Weave as in Weave.

Jamme's companion thought a degraded token would spit someone out at the wrong time. Someone could go forwards, or backwards. Eevon?

Greenways said one of them and the kid are staying in the room because they're 'ill'

Went to Titus. All hands on deck for formal guards. Got a yellow sash from him... which the Illithie paladins were wearing when the kid was abducted. Other sashes are held on by pins of twisted vines. Orders to shut the fuck up.

West wing is Heaving with guards and the ballroom. Nibbles in place. Water with stoppers around. Lord Titus is dressed with silver and the Vine pins. Walking stick is mostly for drip.

Lord Voltrin. Bearded, finely wrought bling, scroll on the belt, just chilling.

Green and gold, woven vines and leaves. Priest of the Eternal Vine. High Priest Tiberius. Kinda tipsy because wine=wisdom. Duh.

Minor aid, thin, stooped, dark robe, bronze ring. Looking smol. Vine ring.

Lorie greenway wearing tunics with clan symbols of Rulith woven into the brocade.

Warrior braids. Seeming chill but alert.

Dawn and Dusk in complimentary vestments fitting their stations.

Lord Ferox wearing flame coloured silk with vines and a wine cup. Solem.

Aid wearing polished outfit, similar colour. Auburn hair. Lee's old school rival.

10/10/2025

ITheorising:

There's at least 1 other party trying to sabotage the summit, possibly the start of a second Ashen Uprising people's revolution

Is the Nat 1 consequence table related to each god? There's 18 in total and 20 consequences, but 1 of them is that the gods are mad at you and another is to just reroll, so thats all of the gods and none of them?

Table set-up: Rulif, Velenar (with Dawn and Dusk) Tayan, Alithi, Eternal Vine, Qavrud

Lori wants peace. "Don't want kids to inheret a war."

"Stand not at a table of peace but an edge of an age. Trade not battlefields. Kinship not conquest."

Titus is investigating the Water Elemental.

Votrin is trying to sell mercenaries as extra protection. Also the children going missing is a known thing and he referenced it?

Ferrox is short but made himself taller and promptly said things one should never say at a Peace Summit, like that the attack is a sign of weak leadership and only those faithful to Virelya can do things right and its the true path for everyone, as well as a lot of ash and flame and ember imagery as if it was code words to signal his allegiance to those in the know.

Sister Vaela (Gilberts ex classmate) reacts to this, but she's in the Qavrud contingent, so why was this a surprise to her?

Dawn was firm about the future blooming not burning but then Dusk said that fire sometimes burns homes and sometimes lights the way and we must keep balance. Dawn is impassive but Ferrox's eye twitched with surprise at the difference in emphasis between Dawn and Dusk

The Eternal Vine guy seems in favour of prosperity coming after hardship specifically in the soil made fertile by ash. He then brings out wine as a peace gesture and we convince them to let us test it just out the door with an aid from every delegation watching us

Lori tried to bring up the attack and Votrin tried to sell Tayan's investigators.

Ferrox shit stirred some more

Ferrox is behaving weird and on a 28 I realised this isn't Ferrox at all!!!! ITS THE FUCKING EMBERHEART POSSESSING HIM!!!!

Though notably Ashley mmhmed when I brought up that Virelya saying they are known by many names seems to imply that the Emberheart is not one of them and thus not a god at all

Titus is genuinely investigating the Octopi bc it was a water elemental, we need to get a warning to them before Uta'h gets his god killed from being too evangelical

Everyone is stressing and looking for someone easy to blame, so we took the chance to frame it as not any specific person here's fault by tweaking the truth:

We found the circle with the wizard's help and he can verify in needed, people at least disguised as Paladins (which Titus seems to take as the truth) and that we didn't have the chance to tell anyone until now bc we spent all of yesterday evening trying to hunt down one of the 'Paladins' who escaped, though Winona also made sure to mention that we had some time to investigate but were very busy, so if anyone recognises us as the ones who looked around this room yesterday they won't be suspicious.

'Ferox' and Dusk have a slight reaction when we get unanimously voted to investigate on everyone's behalf as independent third parties.

Voltrin (for free) says that scholars guild say the Vathyrin religion has an upcoming convergence called the Hour of Flame that may have something to do with the Ashen Uprising but doesn't know when.

Maybe we can spin bringing Jimson and his fellow scholars to collaborate with the scholars guild to investigate more on the Vathyrin and this convergence before going to Ashenhold

A toast of wine was proposed by the Vine priest from the same bottle that was checked. Titus, Votrin and some of the party accepted. Cyrena and Wynona.

Voltrin wanted to focus on trade, obvi. Lori and Titus too.

Ferox was all military. Voltrrin wanted to sell.

Wynona summoned Calamari. Ferox was amused, Titus was unamused, Voltrin was... contemplating. High Priest Big T was drunk. Dawn, Dusk and Lori were just surprised.

Two servants and three guards weren't reacting like normal. Heading to the table and the stage. Not for snacks.

Utah, Wynona and Cyrena got Calamari to the Greenway's suite, and summoned Leira out a closet. Guards swarmed back into the meeting room.

Random staff member muttering 'The Second Dawn Comes'. (Second Ashen Uprising.) Ferox was smirking as Minor Illusion from Gilbert worked... Anti-magic is down.

Initiative happened. Peasants burst in.

A voice hit me with a Suggestion, "Grab the greenway."

Gilber's Ex asked him what he was doing here. He hit her with the 'when did you become a sex toy for Ferox' line. Got a magic missile for his trouble.

Guards at the table wearing Palace Swiss Guard uniform, but tacticool. "We've been marked by the boss" Shinny Armour with a blue sash.

Peasants arrived to destroy the delegations for the good of alithie, no more cake, no military service, all for the free men, and women singing Les Mis.

Voltrin's personal guards just attacked him. Not the ones we seen last night, they're wearing the wrong uniform.

30/10/2025

Previous session, big fight:

Titus has a trans awakening.

Dusk revealed herself.

Gilbert's Ex stopped the Emberheart possessed Ferox from burning us all down.

Cue level up.

Nathan one shot. White light, everyone else was gone, animal people were around taking the place of the others.

Calamari, in human form, knocked at the door. Revealed they were in a dream scape.

Find a personal item here to get the divine intervention of Gilbert's ex saving the day.

Exited to a dreamscape Library with Maedra, into various dreamscape areas relevant to one another. Chamie's forge and a Maedra statue calling her daddy. Baby Manny also. Gilbert had non-copywrite pokemon gambling with his mum and ferox conjoined.

There was a diamond butt plug. Then everyone work up.

Resuming, Ferox and Gilbert's Ex are KO'd on the floor, the atmosphere is confused.

Gilbert went to cradle his ex, while she's unconscious. I tried to get Dusk tied up with one of the turncoat guards.

Peasants called Titus the devil for sealing food and wives. Talked them down to chill for a while while we clean up the mess. Waiting outside while we deal with the mess.

Bound and gagged Dusk and the remaining guards while we investigated.

Talked the Ex into her and her guards disarming in exchange for defence while they're in here. She's known Ferox for about two years. No idea how long Ferox has been possessed.

She arrived in Quvard to pay off debts, met Kedric, 'Ferox's brother', she was invited to the job. Unknown who sent it off, reps of the religion were recruiting. 3-4 others came, she's advanced the quickest. Human man and woman came in plain garb speaking of devotion and revelry of the religion in Quvard. Went with it for the pay check and maybe purpose.

Clan of tortoles were seeking an Artisan.

Ferox's pockets had a holy symbol of Virelia, coin purse, no diamond nipple piercings. Guards didn't have anything on them now that they were disarmed.

Dusk noticed Cyrena heading under the table (me too) and looked surprised to see her scratching at the runes there. She scratched too hard and all the symbols vanished.

Voltron was shook from his guard turning against him and there no bargain going on. Max and mostly Chamie talked him into perking up a little. Offered info about the Ashenhold... for a price. Got a little out of him anyway.

Spies heard of a meeting between Relis, head of the black blades, and Merinth, aka the man. Farqurt's sister. Increase of skirmishes across trade caravan routes. Funds and promissory notes between individuals linked to the black blades. (Not paying taxes)

Lack of raiding happening in the lands around the Ashenhold. Rumours about the Heart of Cinders and a badly translated Vathiran text about the Flame Bringer that scorched the world once. (Not the century ago thing, much older. Another name for the Ember Heart.)

Ashen Hourglass is a time trap of the stolen time reservoir. Shattering it will release the stored time all at once, we'll be speed running the apocalypse. Came from some Vathiran ruins, only just translated this in the last week. Ruins are near the arse end of Tyan, near the main Quvard port.

Dead guards/symbols had flame symbols tucked into their robes, including 'voltrin's and Titus' guards' and the three hanging around and the mages. Just the flame pin. Titus told us to check with the Head of House to confirm identities.

Half the gang got under the table to look at what Cyrena had done. As Ferox was regaining consciousness I tied him up with Cyrena's rope and Utah called for the court mages for a normal anti-magic circle. Ferox's eyes had been golden while possessed but they're now forest green. Eyes have been gold as long as Gilbert's ex knew him. Guards have known him 7-8 years, eyes still green.

When he came to Chamie told him he's been out of it for a while, he last remembered six years ago. Presumable when he's possessed. Seemed genuinely surprised as to the duration.

Last thing he remembers was contemplating/meditating with Virelia.

LEarned the rituals in some meditations while asking for meditations on fire to cleanse the land. Or from a book Kedric found on his journeys 34ish years ago. Somewhere around Rulith. Fire wasn't very well practiced in Virelian religion before this. Book was in Vathiran.

Contemplation before rituals, did the usual Virelian sex ritual parties. As they built the pyres they sat in silence as the spark went forth, praying for the fire to go forth and cleanse the land and bring forth a bountiful harvest. Nothing happened after Samual, Keric then suggested he do himself on the pyre. Within the day rains, life, some lightning strikes for fire. Fish and deer returned. The land itself had been reset, purged.

He doesn't have a brother, Kedric, he died in a sacrifice Took ferox's place in another sacrifice. Kedric's eyes often changed colours from green to gold and back.

Peace was settled 20 years ago after the war with a meeting. Ferox has risen to power in the last seven years and before that the deputy head of Quvard. Samuel McManus. Died about eight years ago mysteriously. Sacrifice in a bonfire to bring a bountiful harvest to the land. In a big wooden statue. Because there was major droughts for years and the usual rituals weren't working.

Court mages set up an anti-magic field around Ferox after Cyrena stuck a hunters mark on him. Also one link (the glass ceiling) is what broke the anti-magic circle in the first place as Calamari came through it.

06/11/25

Of Ferox and Kedric:

Guards heard Kerdic should take Ferox's place in the sacrifice, but he's still been around for the last few years. Ferox didn't actually see Keric burning inside the effigy.

Ferox's travels seemed to take him to the compass points we found in the Kilsa ruins. Costal Rulith, green place to the east, some dungeons, funeral graves. He traveled with an adventuring party who all died in dungeons saving him from traps and the like... they were us.

Someone in Highhill, clerics, might be able to help us either carve runes into Ferox or get jewelry to ward him against possession again.

Head mage was allegedly busy when we sent for the mages. Head mage is missing... Name of Trina McBeth. Tall, angular face, blonde, blue eyes. Last time the other mages seen her was this morning. She made her checks then left, saying she's busy.

Trina was appointed head mage because all the other candidates had ties to political factions opposed to Titus. Trina sent the paige off to tend to the other mages before the summit.

Utah then summoned Maedra... intentionally. With Gilbert's tainted blood. Also probably all our blood was tainted. Divinetouched and all. Maybe. Maedra did the sigil for us... but of course Utah and others made ... some deals with her.

Ferox has never had nipple or dick piercings

Tried to get the leaders back on track for the peace summit. Dawn took the lead and got things back on track.

Chamie got the constructs back. Octobuses and the familiar found the dockworkers nephew? Dead. Maybe their fault, maybe. Lera's... seen some things. Needs hugs. Supposedly there's other octopi. Leria died defending the octopi from the mob they pissed off, woke up to a man saying she had to protect Calamari if she wanted to continue living. When she came back she felt him looking through her senses.

Went to the mage's room. Door was locked. Chamie misty stepped into the room. Glyph went off, seemed to be a Sleep spell. Chamie resisted it.

Intricate rug with metallic thread on the floor, coupled chairs, desk + Chair, magical reference books and the like, map of Illithie + the continent. Knicknacks. Magical. Potions around, crystal ball, etc. In warded cabinets. Big portrait of Titus staring her down. Abjuration on cabinets, door, right desk drawers, sleep glyph too but it's gone off.

Wynona and Utah broke down the door, they and Cyrena took a good sniff of the Mage's scent. Cyrena's nose suggested it was someone we've killed. Heavy, decayed smell... Cyrena's new Paladin things picked up three undead... below us. They seemed to be moving away though. Sent the paige off to get the other mages to cordon off the room for the time being.

Chamie and Cyrena got the front of the drawer off. Wrought iron key with a little skeleton handle, blank book with no writing on the covers, tiny bag of coins worth 88 gold. Book was extra fancy with a bible carry thing. Boys opened it in the courtyard. Strands of energy erupted from it. Green poison hit Gilbert, Fire and Acid hit Utah... Utah went down. Hard.

Chamie swiped a print of the mage's sigil stamp. Big A with a magic hand stylising into the letter.

Hidden seam on the stones under the rug.